

THE COMPLETE AI RESOURCE GUIDE

Tools · Prompting · One-Person Business · The Future of AI

Beginner-Friendly · Structured · Actionable

How to Use This Guide

This guide is split into 4 parts. Don't try to do everything at once. Pick the part that matches where you are right now, and go one section at a time.

Part 1: Tools & Prompting Mindset | **Part 2: One-Person Business** | **Part 3: Prompting by Modality** | **Part 4: The Next Wave of AI**

PART 1

Tools & Prompting Mindset

Section A: AI Tools Stack by Purpose

— You don't need all these tools. Pick ONE from each category that matches your immediate need. Master it before adding more.

Writing & Research

Tool	Best For	Free/Paid	Level	Use Case Example
Claude	Long-form thinking, strategy, reasoning	Free / Paid	Beginner	Write a business proposal with structured arguments
ChatGPT	General writing, quick drafts, brainstorm	Free / Paid	Beginner	Draft 10 email subject lines for a product launch
Perplexity	Real-time research with citations	Free / Paid	Beginner	Research competitor landscape with source links

Image Generation

Tool	Best For	Free/Paid	Level	Use Case Example
Midjourney	High-quality artistic & commercial visuals	Paid	Intermediate	Create brand mood boards and product concepts
DALL-E 3	Quick image gen inside ChatGPT	Free / Paid	Beginner	Generate thumbnail concepts for YouTube videos
Flux (via Replicate)	Photorealistic images, fine-tunable	Free trial	Intermediate	Generate product lifestyle photography mockups

Video Generation

Tool	Best For	Free/Paid	Level	Use Case Example
Runway Gen-3	Cinematic AI video from text/image	Free trial / Paid	Intermediate	Generate b-roll footage for YouTube videos
Kling AI	Realistic motion, good for social content	Free tier / Paid	Beginner	Create short product demo clips
HeyGen	AI avatar videos with custom voice	Free trial / Paid	Beginner	Record explainer videos without being on camera

Presentation

Tool	Best For	Free/Paid	Level	Use Case Example
Gamma	Beautiful decks from text prompts	Free / Paid	Beginner	Turn a business idea into a 10-slide pitch deck
Beautiful.ai	Smart presentation layouts auto-adjust	Paid	Beginner	Create consistent brand presentations
Tome	Narrative-driven AI presentations	Free / Paid	Beginner	Build a one-pager for a new product concept

Automation & Workflows

Tool	Best For	Free/Paid	Level	Use Case Example
Zapier	Connect apps and automate tasks without code	Free / Paid	Beginner	Auto-save email attachments to Google Drive

Make (Integromat)	Visual automation builder, more powerful	Free / Paid	Intermediate	Build a lead capture → CRM → welcome email flow
n8n	Self-hosted open-source automation	Free (self-host)	Intermediate	Build custom AI workflows with full data control

Audio & Music

Tool	Best For	Free/Paid	Level	Use Case Example
Suno	Full songs from text prompts	Free / Paid	Beginner	Generate background music for videos without royalties
ElevenLabs	Realistic AI voice cloning and TTS	Free / Paid	Beginner	Create voiceovers for videos in any accent
Udio	Music generation with fine control	Free / Paid	Beginner	Create genre-specific intro jingles for a podcast

Coding Assistants

Tool	Best For	Free/Paid	Level	Use Case Example
Cursor	AI-first code editor with codebase context	Free / Paid	Intermediate	Refactor an entire React codebase with AI suggestions
GitHub Copilot	Inline code suggestions inside VS Code	Paid	Intermediate	Auto-complete functions and write tests automatically
Bolt.new	Build full apps from a single text prompt	Free / Paid	Beginner	Spin up a working landing page in 5 minutes

AI Search

Tool	Best For	Free/Paid	Level	Use Case Example
Perplexity	Best AI search with cited real-time sources	Free / Paid	Beginner	Research a market trend with cited, up-to-date sources
You.com	AI search with app mode integrations	Free / Paid	Beginner	Search + summarize + create in one interface
Phind	Developer-focused AI search for code	Free / Paid	Beginner	Find exact code syntax with context and examples

Section B: Prompting Mindset Shift

— Surface-level prompting gives you average output. Intentional prompting gives you 10x better results from the exact same tool. The difference is how you think — not what tool you use.

1. Business Strategy

✗ Surface-Level Prompt	✓ Intentional Prompt
<i>Give me startup ideas in AI.</i>	You are a partner at a top VC fund in India. You've seen thousands of startup pitches fail. Identify 3 underserved Indian markets where AI can build a ₹100Cr business in 5 years. For each: explain why incumbents are weak, why demand grows now, and what unfair advantage a 2-person team could have.

2. Content Creation

✗ Surface-Level Prompt	✓ Intentional Prompt
<i>Write me a caption for my product.</i>	I'm launching a productivity app for freelancers in India aged 22–30. Write 5 Instagram captions that speak to the anxiety of missed deadlines and the relief of having systems. Use conversational Hindi-English tone. End each with a CTA.

3. Learning a New Skill

✗ Surface-Level Prompt	✓ Intentional Prompt
<i>Teach me digital marketing.</i>	I'm a complete beginner who wants to learn digital marketing to get my first client in 60 days. I have 1 hour per day. Create a week-by-week learning plan. Be specific: what to learn, what to practice, what to produce. Skip theory-heavy topics I won't use in the first 3 months.

Section C: 5 Advanced Prompting Techniques

Technique	What It Does	Example Prompt
1. Role-Based	Assigns an expert identity to the AI so it reasons from that perspective	"You are a senior UX designer at a top fintech company. Review my app's onboarding flow and give specific, critical feedback on friction points."

2. Pull Prompting	Extracts step-by-step reasoning instead of just asking for an answer	"Walk me through your thinking step by step before giving a final answer. What assumptions are you making? What would change your conclusion?"
3. Steelmanning	Stress-tests your idea by asking for the strongest possible counter-argument	"My startup idea is X. What is the single strongest argument that this will fail? Don't soften it — be as critical as possible."
4. Constraint-Based	Adds specific limits to force more focused, creative output	"Explain machine learning to a 12-year-old using only a cooking analogy. Max 150 words. No jargon."
5. Chain-of-Thought	Breaks complex problems into sequential reasoning steps	"Let's think through this step by step. First, identify the problem. Then list possible solutions. Then evaluate trade-offs. Then recommend one. Go."

Section D: 4-Week AI Fluency Roadmap

— Don't rush. One week = one focus area. By the end of Week 4, you'll have real hands-on experience with 4–5 tools and your first AI workflow.

Week	What to Learn	What to Practice	Tools to Try	End-of-Week Outcome
Week 1 Foundations	How AI models work at a high level. What they're good at, where they fail.	Write 10 prompts on topics you care about. Compare results with different phrasings.	Claude / ChatGPT	<i>You've done 10+ intentional prompts and noticed what changes output quality.</i>
Week 2 Prompting	Role-based, constraint, and chain-of-thought prompting.	Take 3 real tasks from your life/work. Solve each one using structured prompts.	Claude, Perplexity	<i>You've solved 3 real problems using AI — not just played with it.</i>
Week 3 Tools Exploration	Explore one new category: images OR automation OR video.	Build one mini-project: a mood board, a short reel, or an automated workflow.	Midjourney / Runway / Zapier	<i>You've shipped one real AI-assisted output (image set, video, or automation).</i>
Week 4 Workflow	How to chain tools together into a repeatable system.	Pick one recurring task and build a workflow that uses 2+ AI tools.	Zapier + Claude, or Gamma + Perplexity	<i>You have one working AI workflow that saves you real time every week.</i>

PART 2

One-Person AI Business

Section A: 8 Business Models AI Unlocks

— These aren't side hustles. These are leverage plays — where AI does the work that would previously require a team of 3–5 people.

Business Model	What AI Replaces	Revenue Ceiling	Human Edge Needed	Best Starting Tool
AI-Powered Freelance Design	Junior designers, revisions, ideation time	₹15–50L/yr	Taste, client communication, brand strategy	Midjourney + Figma
Newsletter / Content Business	Writers, editors, researchers, formatters	₹10–40L/yr	Unique POV, audience trust, curation judgment	Claude + Beehiiv
No-Code App Builder	Developers, testers, basic UI/UX	₹25–1Cr/yr	Problem identification, product intuition	Bolt.new + Supabase
AI Video Agency	Video editors, scriptwriters, voice artists	₹20–60L/yr	Creative direction, client relationships	Runway + HeyGen
B2B Lead Gen Service	SDRs, research analysts, outreach teams	₹30–80L/yr	Industry expertise, relationship-building	Clay + Apollo
Online Course / Cohort	Curriculum designers, video editors, support	₹10–50L/yr	Domain authority, teaching ability	Claude + Kajabi
AI Consulting / Prompting	Junior consultants, research analysts	₹20–70L/yr	Systems thinking, industry knowledge	Claude + Notion
Niche Research Reports	Research teams, analysts, writers	₹8–30L/yr	Niche expertise, synthesis judgment	Perplexity + Claude

Section B: AI Business Stack by Type

Freelance Creative

Function	Tool(s)	What It Does / Replaces	Est. Monthly Cost
Research	Perplexity	Market research, competitor analysis	~₹0
Content	Claude + Midjourney	Proposals, copy, visuals	~₹2,500/mo
Outreach	Apollo + ChatGPT	Cold email, LinkedIn scripts	~₹2,000/mo
Operations	Notion AI + Zapier	Project tracking, invoicing	~₹1,500/mo
Delivery	Gamma + Figma	Client deliverables, presentations	~₹1,000/mo

Info Product Creator

Function	Tool(s)	What It Does / Replaces	Est. Monthly Cost
Research	Perplexity + Claude	Topic research, audience insights	~₹500/mo
Content	Claude + Descript	Course scripts, video editing	~₹3,000/mo
Outreach	Beehiiv + ConvertKit	Email marketing, newsletters	~₹2,500/mo
Operations	Zapier + Notion	Automation, content calendar	~₹1,500/mo
Delivery	Kajabi / Gumroad	Course hosting, payment	~₹2,000/mo

B2B Service Provider

Function	Tool(s)	What It Does / Replaces	Est. Monthly Cost
Research	Clay + Apollo	Lead research, company profiling	~₹5,000/mo
Content	Claude + Gamma	Proposals, case studies, decks	~₹2,500/mo
Outreach	Instantly + Clay	Personalized cold email at scale	~₹4,000/mo
Operations	HubSpot Free + Zapier	CRM, follow-up automation	~₹2,000/mo
Delivery	Notion + Loom	Deliverables, async client comms	~₹500/mo

App / SaaS Builder

Function	Tool(s)	What It Does / Replaces	Est. Monthly Cost
Research	Perplexity + Reddit	Market validation, user pain points	~₹0

Content	Claude + Framer	Landing page copy, marketing	~₹2,000/mo
Outreach	Product Hunt + X (Twitter)	Launch strategy, distribution	~₹0
Operations	Supabase + Vercel	Backend, deployment infrastructure	~₹1,000/mo
Delivery	Bolt.new + Cursor	Build and iterate the product	~₹2,500/mo

Section C: AI Workflow Design

— A workflow isn't just using multiple tools. It's connecting them so output from one feeds the next — with minimal manual work in between.

Workflow 1: Client Acquisition

#	Step	Tool	What Happens	Human or AI?
1	Lead Research	Clay + Apollo	Find 100 target companies matching your ICP automatically	AI
2	Company Research	Perplexity	Pull key info: funding, news, recent hires for each lead	AI
3	Personalized Outreach	Claude + Instantly	Write personalized cold emails using company context	AI drafts, human reviews
4	Follow-Up Sequence	Instantly	Auto-send 3-step follow-up if no reply in 3 days	AI
5	CRM Update	Zapier → HubSpot	Auto-log all interactions and status to CRM	AI
6	Meeting Booking	Calendly	Auto-book calls when prospects respond positively	AI

🕒 *Estimated time saved: 8–10 hours per week*

Workflow 2: Content Production

#	Step	Tool	What Happens	Human or AI?
1	Idea Generation	Claude + Perplexity	Generate 20 content ideas based on trending topics in your niche	AI

2	Research	Perplexity	Deep-dive research on chosen topic with citations	AI
3	Draft	Claude	Write full first draft from research + outline	AI drafts, human edits
4	Visuals	Midjourney / Canva AI	Generate header image and in-post graphics	AI
5	Publish	Buffer / Beehiiv	Auto-schedule and publish to all platforms	AI
6	Repurpose	Claude + Zapier	Auto-convert long-form to Twitter thread, LinkedIn post, reel script	AI

🕒 *Estimated time saved: 6–8 hours per week*

Section D: 30-60-90 Day Business Roadmap

Phase	What to Build	What to Automate	Metrics to Hit
Day 1–30Foundation	Pick 1 business model. Set up your core tool stack. Create 3 portfolio samples using AI.	Content repurposing workflow. Basic lead list from Apollo.	3 portfolio pieces live. Outreach to 30 potential clients. 2–3 discovery calls booked.
Day 31–60First Revenue	Close first 1–2 clients. Build your core delivery workflow. Create case study from first project.	Client onboarding flow. Invoice & contract via Dubsado or Notion.	First ₹25,000–50,000 revenue. 1 case study. Referral ask sent to first client.
Day 61–90Scale Systems	Build a repeatable lead gen system. Raise prices. Productize your core service into packages.	Full client acquisition workflow. Content + distribution fully automated.	₹1L+ monthly revenue run rate. 3+ active clients. AI does 70%+ of execution work.

PART 3

Prompting by Modality

Section A: Text Prompting (LLMs)

— Text models don't just autocomplete — they reason. The more context and structure you give, the better they reason.

The 5 Core Components

Component	What It Means	Example
Role	Who should the AI behave as?	"You are a senior product manager at a B2B SaaS company..."
Goal	What's the exact task?	"...help me write a PRD for a new feature."
Context	Background info the AI needs	"The feature is for enterprise customers who need audit logs."
Constraints	Limits on format, length, tone	"Keep it under 500 words. Use bullet points. Avoid jargon."
Output Format	How you want the result structured	"Return: Problem statement, User stories (5), Acceptance criteria."

5 Ready-to-Use Text Prompt Templates

Strategic Thinking

You are a business strategist. I'm considering [decision]. Walk me through the key trade-offs, risks, and what information I'd need to make a confident choice. Think step by step.

Learning a Skill

I want to learn [skill] in [timeframe]. I have [X hours/week]. I'm a [beginner/intermediate]. Create a practical week-by-week plan. Skip theory I won't use immediately.

Writing

Write a [format] about [topic] for [audience]. Tone: [conversational/professional]. Length: [X words]. Include: [specific elements]. Avoid: [things to skip].

Analysis

Analyze [thing] from the perspective of [expert type]. What are the 3 most important insights? What's the most common mistake people make about this? What would you do differently?

Roleplay/Simulation

Simulate a [job interview / negotiation / difficult conversation] with me. You play [role]. I'll respond as myself. Give me real-time feedback after each of my responses on what I did well and what to improve.

Section B: Image Prompting

— Image models don't reason — they paint. Don't explain what you mean, describe what you see. Be a film director, not a writer.

Anatomy of a Strong Image Prompt

Element	Examples	Pro Tip
Subject	"A young Indian founder"	Be specific — describe appearance, expression, pose
Style	"cinematic, photorealistic, editorial"	Combine 2 styles: "editorial + dark luxury"
Lighting	"dramatic side lighting, golden hour"	Lighting is 50% of mood — never skip it
Composition	"close-up, rule of thirds, overhead shot"	Camera position changes the feeling completely
Color Palette	"blue-orange contrast, muted tones"	Limit to 2–3 colors for a professional look
Mood	"tense, optimistic, mysterious"	Mood should match your brand or use case
Quality Modifiers	"8K, ultra-detailed, award-winning"	Add at end: "shot on Hasselblad, Vogue editorial"

Midjourney Parameters Cheat Sheet

Parameter	What It Does	Example
--ar	Aspect ratio of the output	--ar 16:9 (YouTube), --ar 9:16 (Reels), --ar 1:1 (posts)
--v 6	Model version (always use latest)	--v 6 for most realistic results
--style raw	Less AI-fied, more photographic	Use for product shots and portraits
--chaos	Randomness / variety (0–100)	--chaos 20 for slight variety, --chaos 80 for wild output
--no	Negative prompt (exclude elements)	--no text, watermark, blurry, extra fingers
--seed	Reproduce a result exactly	--seed 12345 (copy seed from a result you liked)

Section C: Video Prompting

Video = image + motion + time. If you don't describe movement, the video will look like a slideshow. Always describe: what moves, how it moves, and at what pace.

5 Elements Every Video Prompt Needs

Element	What to Include	Example
Scene	Setting, subjects, time of day	"Rooftop in Mumbai at sunset, a young man standing alone"
Motion	What moves and how	"His jacket moves slowly in the wind, city lights flicker below"
Camera	Camera angle and movement	"Slow push-in from wide to medium close-up"
Timing/Pace	Speed of the scene	"5-second slow-motion clip, dreamlike pace"
Atmosphere	Mood, color grade, feel	"Cinematic, warm amber grade, tense but hopeful mood"

Section D: Code Prompting

Vague code prompts = messy code. Tell the AI your stack, your constraints, and your exact expected output — like a spec document, not a wish.

Anatomy of a Strong Code Prompt

Element	What to Include	Example
Stack	Language, framework, libraries	"React + Tailwind + TypeScript + Supabase"
Feature	Exact feature to build	"A user authentication flow with email + Google OAuth"
Inputs/Outputs	What goes in, what comes out	"Input: email + password → Output: JWT token stored in cookie"
UI Requirements	Layout and component details	"Clean form, email + password fields, 'Sign in with Google' button, error states"
Constraints	Rules to follow	"No third-party auth libraries. Use Supabase Auth only."
Avoid	Common mistakes to skip	"Don't use localStorage for tokens. Don't use class components."

Section E: Master Prompt Cheat Sheet

One-page reference for all 4 prompting modalities:

Text (LLMs)	Image (Midjourney/Flux)	Video (Runway/Kling)	Code (Cursor/Claude)
• Role (who) • Goal (what) • Context (why) • Constraints • Output format	• Subject (who/what) • Style + lighting • Composition + camera • Color palette + mood • --ar --v --no params	• Scene description • What moves + how • Camera movement • Pace + duration • Atmosphere + grade	• Tech stack • Feature to build • Inputs + outputs • UI requirements • Constraints + avoid

PART 4

The Next Wave of AI

Section A: From Generation to Execution

—	Current AI: you ask, it answers. Next-wave AI: you give a goal, it figures out the steps and does them.
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Current AI (Generative)	Next Wave AI (Agentic)
You prompt. It responds.	You set a goal. It plans and executes.
One task at a time.	Multi-step workflows, autonomously.
Needs a human in the loop every step.	Runs independently, checks in on decisions.
Creates outputs (text, images, code).	Completes objectives (research, outreach, build).
Tools: ChatGPT, Claude, Midjourney	Tools: AutoGPT, Devin, Computer Use, Operator

Agent Timeline (Realistic)

Horizon	What Agents Can Do
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Now (2025)	Research + summarize, write + publish, basic web browsing, code generation, form-filling. Still needs human review.
1 Year (2026)	Multi-step business workflows, reliable long-horizon tasks, voice-controlled agents, agentic coding entire features.
3 Years (2027–28)	End-to-end project execution, AI employees with memory, physical-world agents via robotics.
5 Years (2030)	AI agents running entire operational layers of businesses. Human role shifts to judgment and strategy.

Section B: Open-Source AI

— Open-source AI means you can run powerful models on your own machine — privately, cheaply, and with full customization. This changes the economics of building AI products forever.

Model	Made by	What It's Good For
Llama 3.3	Meta	General purpose, best open-source for most tasks. Rivals GPT-4o.
Mistral / Mixtral	Mistral AI	Fast, efficient. Great for code and structured reasoning.
Qwen 2.5	Alibaba	Strong multilingual + code. Good for non-English tasks.
Phi-4	Microsoft	Small but powerful. Runs on a laptop. Great for edge devices.
DeepSeek R1	DeepSeek	Strong reasoning model, open-source, rivals o1.

Tools to Run AI Locally (No Coding Required)

Tool	What It Does	Who Should Use It
Ollama	Run open-source LLMs locally via terminal	Developers or technical beginners who want privacy
LM Studio	Run LLMs locally with a beautiful GUI	Non-coders who want to try local AI with no setup
Hugging Face	Browse + download thousands of open-source models	Anyone researching or experimenting with AI models
Jan.ai	Open-source ChatGPT alternative, runs offline	People who want a private, local AI assistant

Section C: Industry Disruption Map

Industry	AI Is Already Doing	Coming in 2–3 Years	What Humans Still Win At
Healthcare	Disease detection, drug discovery acceleration	<i>AI diagnosticians, personalized treatment plans</i>	Patient trust, ethical decisions, empathy
Education	Personalized tutoring, content generation	<i>AI teachers that adapt in real-time to every student</i>	Mentorship, motivation, human connection
Creative Industries	Image, music, video generation	<i>Full AI film production pipelines</i>	Taste, original vision, cultural nuance
Software Dev	Code generation, debugging, test writing	<i>AI that builds entire features end-to-end</i>	Architecture decisions, product judgment
Sales & Marketing	Copywriting, lead research, ad creative	<i>Fully autonomous outreach and conversion funnels</i>	Relationship-building, brand strategy
Finance	Report generation, market analysis summaries	<i>AI portfolio managers, automated financial planning</i>	Risk judgment, client trust, ethics
Legal	Contract review, research, document drafting	<i>AI legal assistants for routine legal work</i>	Courtroom advocacy, strategic counsel

Section D: What Actually Becomes Valuable

— When intelligence gets cheap, scarcity shifts. The valuable things become: judgment, taste, trust, creativity, and the ability to decide what's worth building.

What Becomes Scarce	Why AI Can't Replace It	How to Develop It
Judgment	AI generates options. Humans decide which option matters.	Make real decisions with real stakes. Reflect on outcomes.
Taste	AI can copy styles. Only humans develop original aesthetic instincts.	Consume widely. Build opinions. Ship work and get feedback.
Trust	AI doesn't have skin in the game. Humans do.	Build in public. Be consistent. Show your thinking.
Creative Vision	AI recombines what exists. Humans imagine what doesn't.	Work on original projects. Develop a strong point of view.

Domain Expertise	AI is broad. Experts go deep in ways AI can't fully replicate.	Go deep on one vertical. Build AI tools for that niche.
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Section E: 90-Day Action Plan

— Don't just consume AI content. Build something. Produce something. Signal credibility through output, not knowledge.

Phase	What to Learn	What to Build / Try	Communities to Join	What to Produce
Days 1–30 Explore	AI agents basics. Try Perplexity + Claude for deep research. Install Ollama.	Build a personal AI research workflow. Try Bolt.new for one small app idea.	Twitter/X AI lists. Lenny's Newsletter. Latent Space podcast.	<i>1 case study post on LinkedIn/X about your AI experiment.</i>
Days 31–60 Build	Automation with n8n or Make. Prompt engineering for your use case.	Build a working AI workflow that solves a real problem for yourself or others.	Buildspace community. HackerNews "Who is Building" threads.	<i>Demo video of your workflow. Share it publicly.</i>
Days 61–90 Signal	Fine-tuning basics on Hugging Face. Agent frameworks: LangChain or CrewAI.	Launch a micro-product (template, mini-course, tool) built with AI.	AI entrepreneurs communities on Discord. IndieHackers.com.	<i>Portfolio page with 3 AI projects. A short PDF guide or tool that proves expertise.</i>

The window is open. But it won't stay open forever.

Pick one thing from this guide. Apply it this week. That's how real leverage starts.